Nicholas Rode

Product & Interactive Motion Designer

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SUMMARY

Product and interactive motion designer for AI and SaaS companies, including Gong, Fireworks AI, and Deepgram. I use whatever gets motion shipped (Rive, Lottie, After Effects, Figma, or code) and build AI tools that close the gap between design and production.

EXPERIENCE

Motion Designer, Webstacks Jan 2025 – Present

B2B web design and development agency

- Shipped interactive motion, animation, and illustration for Gong and Fireworks AI, including product UI motion for Fireworks AI
- Built 4 interactive Rive product demos for Deepgram's AI voice platform: voice-to-text, voice avatars, assistant states, and a Slack integration walkthrough
- Designed a 10-piece Rive animation system for Shep's rebrand, turning automation, security, and scale into one visual language
- Choose and optimize animation runtimes for mobile web performance
- Ship production Rive state machines with reduced-motion support and cross-device playback

Junior Designer (Product UI & Motion), Variable Medium Jan 2021 – Dec 2024

- Designed the desktop and mobile peer-to-peer trading app for Evaluate, from interactive prototypes for user testing through launch, plus its marketing site and onboarding video
- Designed trade and chat flows, including asynchronous offers with expiry dates so traders don't need to be online at the same time
- Built advanced interactive prototypes for user testing and developer handoff
- Contributed to design system development and created motion that clarified complex product flows

Freelance Motion Designer & Illustrator, Self-employed Jul 2024 – Present

- Deliver motion graphics, illustration, and web and mobile design for tech, SaaS, and B2B clients

TOOLS I'VE BUILT

Stroke Center (Figma Community): Plugin that converts inside/outside strokes to center for clean Lottie export.

Design to Webpage: AI skill that turns Figma designs into working HTML prototypes with interactions and motion.

Sequence to Shader: AI-built pipeline that turns After Effects renders into lightweight WebGL shaders.

Figma → React: Figma plugin that generates reliable React code from designs.

SKILLS

Motion & interaction: Rive (state machines, interactive components), After Effects, Lottie/Bodymovin, UI animation, 2D/3D animation, compositing

Design: Figma (including motion), Illustrator, UI/UX design, design systems, interactive prototyping

Production & performance: Rive web runtimes (React, Canvas, WebGL2), Lottie JSON delivery, WebGL shaders, Lighthouse performance tuning, reduced-motion accessibility, developer handoff

AI & building: Claude Code, AI-assisted tool building, Figma plugin development

EDUCATION

Art Institute of Seattle
Nucamp, Full Stack Web Design 2020

COURSES

Rive Masterclass
TheMotionMagic, Ultimate Rive Animation Course
School of Motion, A Motion Design Masterpiece